



CHITEKESA

COMMUNITY DAY SECONDARY SCHOOL

ALUMNI ASSOCIATION

"TOGETHER WE MAKE THE DIFFERENCE"

CONSTITUTION

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DEFINITIONS

CDSS: Community Day Secondary School

ALUMNI: Former students of Chitekesa Community Day Secondary School

ASSOCIATION: Chitekesa CDSS Alumni Association

EC: Executive Committee

AGM: Annual General Meeting

BOARD: The executive committee or any other committee

NGO: Non-Governmental Organization

CBO: Community Based Organization

THE PREAMBLE

Chitekesa Community Day Secondary School Alumni Association (hereinafter referred to as "the Association") is a Malawian-based non-profit organization comprising former students of Chitekesa CDSS who are committed to fostering unity, mutual support, and community development. Established out of a shared sense of belonging and the desire to give back, the Association aims to harness the collective strengths and resources of its alumni to promote the growth of Chitekesa CDSS, support current students, and contribute meaningfully to the socioeconomic development of the communities in which its members live and work. Guided by the motto "Together We Make the Difference," the Association envisions a brotherhood and sisterhood of alumni working in harmony to elevate one another and the school that shaped them.

MOTTO: "TOGETHER WE MAKE THE DIFFERENCE"

POWERS OF THE ASSOCIATION

The Association shall have powers to own or lease property, acquire movable and immovable assets, and to access donations and grants for the purpose of implementing the Association's objectives. All property and funds of the Association shall be used solely for the purposes of the Association, controlled by and answerable to the executive body.

ARTICLE 1

SECTION 1.1: NAME AND ESTABLISHMENT

The name of the Alumni Association shall be called Chitekesa Community Day Secondary School Alumni Association, abbreviated as CHITEKESA CDSS ALUMNI ASSOCIATION.

SECTION 1.2: LOCATION OF ESTABLISHMENT

The Association shall be linked to Chitekesa Community Day Secondary School. Its operations shall extend to wherever members of the Alumni are based in Malawi and beyond.

SECTION 1.3: CONTACT ADDRESS

The contact address of the Association shall be maintained by the Secretary General and shall be updated as necessary. All official communications shall be channelled through the Secretary General.

SECTION 1.4: TARGET GROUP

The Association shall comprise all former students who studied at Chitekesa CDSS. It shall also extend its development activities to the Chitekesa CDSS school community, including current students, teachers, and surrounding communities.

SECTION 1.5: VISION

The vision of the Association is to see a united, empowered, and impactful alumni body that drives transformation at Chitekesa CDSS and contributes to the socioeconomic development of Malawi, guided by the spirit of togetherness.

ARTICLE 2

SECTION 2.1: MISSION STATEMENT

The mission of the Association is "To unite Chitekesa CDSS alumni in fostering academic excellence, community development, and mutual support, while preserving and advancing the legacy of Chitekesa CDSS for generations to come."

SECTION 2.2: OBJECTIVES

The objectives of the Association shall be:

1. To create a strong network of Chitekesa CDSS alumni for mutual support and professional development.
2. To provide financial and material support to needy current students at Chitekesa CDSS.
3. To raise funds for the development and improvement of infrastructure and resources at Chitekesa CDSS.
4. To organize academic mentorship programmes for current students of Chitekesa CDSS.
5. To promote career guidance and professional development among members and current students.
6. To organize social events that foster a sense of community and celebrate shared heritage.
7. To represent the interests of alumni in matters relating to Chitekesa CDSS.
8. To collaborate with stakeholders including government, NGOs, and private sector for the development of Chitekesa CDSS and surrounding communities.
9. To promote civic responsibility, integrity, and good values among alumni.
10. To document and preserve the history and achievements of Chitekesa CDSS and its alumni.

ARTICLE 3

SECTION 3.1: METHODOLOGY / STRATEGIES OF OPERATION AND ACTIVITIES

- Organizing Annual General Meetings and social gatherings to maintain alumni cohesion.
- Conducting fundraising drives for school development projects and student welfare.
- Facilitating career workshops, symposia, and mentorship programmes for current students.
- Partnering with organizations aligned with the Association's objectives.
- Implementing welfare support systems for members experiencing difficulties.
- Maintaining an active alumni register and digital platforms for communication.

- Organizing community outreach and service activities involving alumni and current students.

ARTICLE 4

SECTION 4.1: FINANCE

The revenue of the Association shall be drawn from membership fees, fundraising activities, donations, grants, sponsorships, and any other lawfully acquired income.

All funds and materials of the Association shall be used solely for the purposes of the Association and in a manner approved by the Executive Committee.

There shall be at least three signatories required during each withdrawal of funds, namely the President, the Treasurer General, and the Secretary General.

All financial transactions shall be properly recorded and subject to annual auditing.

No member of the Association shall use Association funds for personal benefit.

SECTION 4.2: FUNDS EMBEZZLEMENT

In case of embezzlement of Association funds by any member, the following measures shall be taken:

- The member concerned shall be immediately reported to the Executive Committee and shall be suspended forthwith pending thorough investigation.
- A commission of inquiry shall be constituted by the Executive Committee to investigate the matter.
- If the concerned member is found guilty: (i) where the embezzled funds can be fully recovered from their earnings, the Association shall use its constitutional powers to recover the funds within a stated period; (ii) where the embezzled funds exceed the member's earnings, the Executive Committee shall decide on appropriate punitive measures; (iii) failure to pay back shall result in legal measures being taken.

ARTICLE 5

SECTION 5.1: ASSOCIATION STRUCTURE

There shall be a body consisting of:

- The Executive Committee
- The Disciplinary Committee
- The General Membership

SECTION 5.2: PATRON / PATRON-IN-CHIEF

The Association may invite a distinguished person, including but not limited to the Head Teacher of Chitekesa CDSS, to serve as Patron of the Association. The Patron shall serve in an advisory capacity and shall have no voting rights.

SECTION 5.3: REMOVAL OF EXECUTIVE MEMBERS

An executive member shall cease to hold office in the following circumstances:

- Death
- Voluntary resignation submitted in writing to the Secretary General
- Removal by vote of no confidence passed by a two-thirds majority of the Executive Committee
- Failure to attend three consecutive executive meetings without satisfactory excuse
- Failure to observe the Constitution and regulations of the Association
- Conviction of a criminal offence

SECTION 5.4: VACANCY

In the event of a vacancy in any executive position, the Executive Committee shall organize a by-election within 30 days of the vacancy arising. The person elected shall serve the remainder of the term.

ARTICLE 6

SECTION 6.1: EXECUTIVE BODY

The executive body of the Association shall consist of the following positions:

1. President

2. Vice President
3. Secretary General
4. Assistant Secretary General
5. Treasurer General
6. Deputy Treasurer
7. Publicity Secretary
8. Organizing Secretary
9. Welfare Director
10. Disciplinary Chairperson (with four additional Disciplinary Committee members:
Disciplinary Secretary, Vice Disciplinary Chair, legal advisor and one other member)
11. Financial Auditor
12. Committee Members / Executive Advisors (maximum of four)

SECTION 6.2: TERM OF OFFICE

Each executive member shall hold office for a period of THREE (3) YEARS from the date of election. At the expiry of the term, elections shall be held. An executive member may seek re-election for a second and final consecutive term in the same position. No person shall hold the same position for more than two consecutive terms.

SECTION 6.3: DUTIES OF THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

The executive board shall collectively be responsible for:

- Day-to-day administration of the Association's activities.
- Implementation and supervision of the activities and programmes of the Association.
- Monitoring the progress and impact of the Association's activities.
- Preparing and presenting reports at Annual General Meetings.
- Evaluating the impact of activities on members and beneficiaries.
- Raising funds and writing proposals for developmental programmes.
- Ensuring compliance with this Constitution.

SECTION 6.4: THE PRESIDENT

There shall be a President elected by members of the Association to head the executive body. The President shall be answerable to the general membership. The following shall be the duties of the President:

- To be the head and chief overseer of all Executive officers and to chair executive meetings.
- To be responsible, together with the executive body, for the implementation of decisions of the Association.
- To supervise all policies and work plans of the Association.
- To present the general progress of the Association at the Annual General Meeting.
- To be accountable for all activities and transactions of the Association.
- To represent the Association at any meeting, workshop, seminar, or symposium, or to appoint a representative from the Executive Committee.
- To summon executive meetings at any time deemed necessary.
- To dismiss incompetent members of the Board upon approval of the Executive Committee.
- To sign official documents and financial instruments on behalf of the Association.

SECTION 6.5: VICE PRESIDENT

There shall be a Vice President elected by members of the Association. The Vice President shall be responsible for:

- Assisting and supporting the efforts of the President.
- Acting as an advisor to the President.
- Assuming the responsibilities and duties of the President during his/her absence, incapacitation, or vacancy.
- Performing all such duties as may be assigned to him/her by the President.
- Supporting and helping all efforts of the Executive body.

- Overseeing special projects and programmes as assigned by the President.

SECTION 6.6: SECRETARY GENERAL

There shall be a Secretary General elected by members of the Association. The Secretary General shall be responsible for:

- Maintaining and safeguarding all documents, records, and correspondence of the Association.
- Initiating resource development proposals and activities.
- Serving as secretary at all executive meetings and general assemblies.
- Providing minutes and agendas of all meetings to the executive body and members.
- Managing the official communication channels of the Association.
- Coordinating with other executive members to ensure smooth administrative operations.
- Maintaining the official register of members.
- Issuing notice of meetings to all members.

SECTION 6.7: ASSISTANT SECRETARY GENERAL

There shall be an Assistant Secretary General elected by members of the Association. The Assistant Secretary General shall be responsible for:

- Assisting the Secretary General in all administrative and secretarial duties.
- Maintaining accurate and up-to-date records of the Association.
- Acting as Secretary General in the absence or incapacitation of the Secretary General.
- Handling correspondence as directed by the Secretary General.
- Carrying out any other duties assigned by the Secretary General or the President.

SECTION 6.8: TREASURER GENERAL

There shall be a Treasurer General elected by members of the Association. The Treasurer General shall be responsible for:

- Accounting for all financial transactions of the Association.
- Keeping the Association's funds and maintaining all necessary books of accounts.

- Initiating fundraising ventures with the approval of the executive body.
- Drawing up a plan of action and the annual budget of the Association, and advising the Executive Committee and General Assembly on financial matters.
- Submitting the annual budget for approval by the Executive Committee and endorsement by the President.
- Submitting books of accounts to the Financial Auditor at the end of each financial year, with the auditor's report made available to all members.
- Presenting an annual financial statement to the Annual General Meeting.
- Ensuring that no funds are disbursed without proper authorization.

SECTION 6.9: DEPUTY TREASURER

There shall be a Deputy Treasurer elected by members of the Association. The Deputy Treasurer shall be responsible for:

- Assisting the Treasurer General in entering financial data accurately and promptly.
- Being transparent and accountable in maintaining proper records and financial documents.
- Representing the Treasurer General in his/her absence or incapacitation.
- Carrying out any other duties assigned by the Treasurer General.

SECTION 6.10: PUBLICITY SECRETARY

There shall be a Publicity Secretary elected by members of the Association. The publicity Secretary shall be responsible for:

- Inform members and the public about meetings, events, projects and achievements of the association
- Create and share updates on Facebook, WhatsApp and other official communication channels
- Draft notices, press releases, posters and advertisements related to association activities
- Encourage former students to join the association and participate in its activities

- Ensure the information shared about the association is accurate and presents the association positively
- Take photographs, collect reports and publish summaries of meetings, projects and events
- Liaise with the school administration, sponsors, partners, and the community on matters related to publicity
- Ensure members receive timely information regarding meetings, elections, fundraising activities and other important matters
- Coordinate with president, secretary General and committee members to design or produce banners, flyers and other promotion materials

SECTION 6.11: ORGANIZING SECRETARY

There shall be an Organizing Secretary elected by members of the Association. The Organizing Secretary shall be responsible for:

- Planning, coordinating, and executing all events, activities, and programmes of the Association.
- Delivering events on time and within the approved budget.
- Conducting on-site inspections and managing logistics for events.
- Providing motivation, direction, and support to event teams.
- Managing all events budgets from start to finish in collaboration with the Treasurer General.
- Serving as spokesperson for events and activities of the Association.
- Producing publicity material for publications and events in collaboration with the President.
- Administering all Association digital platforms and social media channels.

SECTION 6.12: WELFARE DIRECTOR

There shall be a Welfare Director elected by members of the Association. The Welfare Director shall be responsible for:

- Looking after the welfare of all members of the Association.

- Coordinating welfare activities including support for bereaved members and members in distress.
- Identifying and assessing welfare needs of members and presenting proposals to the Executive Committee.
- Facilitating welfare contributions and disbursements as approved by the Executive Committee.
- Fostering social cohesion among members through community activities.
- Maintaining records of all welfare activities and beneficiaries.

SECTION 6.13: DISCIPLINARY COMMITTEE

There shall be a Disciplinary Committee comprising the following members:

- Disciplinary Chairperson
- Vice Disciplinary Chair
- Disciplinary Secretary
- Legal Advisor
- One (1) Additional Disciplinary Committee Member

All members of the Disciplinary Committee shall be elected by the general membership at the time of the main elections.

The duties of the Disciplinary Committee shall be:

- Upholding discipline and good conduct among all members of the Association.
- Receiving, investigating, and adjudicating on disciplinary matters referred to it by the Executive Committee or any member.
- Making recommendations on appropriate sanctions to the Executive Committee.
- Hearing appeals from members disciplined by the Executive Committee.
- Ensuring fair and impartial handling of all disciplinary proceedings.
- Submitting reports of all disciplinary proceedings to the Executive Committee.

The Disciplinary Chairperson shall preside over all Disciplinary Committee proceedings. The Disciplinary Secretary shall keep records of all proceedings. The Vice Disciplinary Chair shall act in the absence of the Disciplinary chairperson.

SECTION 6.14: FINANCIAL AUDITOR

There shall be a Financial Auditor elected by the general membership of the Association. The Financial Auditor shall:

- Conduct an independent audit of the Association's finances at the end of each financial year.
- Have unrestricted access to all books of accounts, financial records, and documents of the Association at any time.
- Present the annual audit report to the Executive Committee and to the Annual General Meeting.
- Flag any financial irregularities to the Executive Committee without delay.
- Sign financial documents as one of the three authorized signatories.
- The Financial Auditor shall not simultaneously hold any other executive position in the Association.

SECTION 6.15: COMMITTEE MEMBERS / EXECUTIVE ADVISORS

There shall be a maximum of four (4) Committee Members/Executive Advisors elected by the general membership. They shall:

- Attend and actively participate in every executive meeting.
- Advise the Executive body on matters relevant to the Association.
- Represent the interests of the general membership within the executive forum.
- Assist the Executive body in implementation of decisions and programmes.
- Undertake any specific assignments delegated to them by the President.

ARTICLE 7

SECTION 7.1: CONSTITUTION AMENDMENTS

The Constitution may be amended by resolution of the executive members passed at a Special General Meeting convened for that purpose. Any amendment, repeal of any section, or addition of a new section proposed by any member shall require the approval of not less than two-thirds of the total membership of the Executive Committee. A copy of proposed amendments shall be sent to all members at least twenty-one (21) days prior to the meeting at which the proposed amendment is to be voted upon. Any amendment shall come into effect upon approval by the Executive Committee.

ARTICLE 8

SECTION 8.1: EXECUTIVE MEETINGS

The Executive Committee shall hold regular meetings at least once every three months, or more frequently as deemed necessary. The quorum for executive meetings shall be at least fifty percent (50%) of executive members. Extraordinary meetings may be convened by the President at any time or upon written request by at least one-third of the executive members. There shall be monthly meetings of the Association, the schedule of which shall be communicated by the Secretary General.

SECTION 8.2: GENERAL ASSEMBLY / ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

There shall be an Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Association held once every year. The quorum for the General Assembly shall be at least fifty percent (50%) of fully registered members including fifty percent (50%) of the executive. The Secretary General shall give at least fourteen (14) days' notice of the AGM to all members. In the absence of a quorum, the meeting shall be adjourned and reconvened within fourteen days at which point those present shall constitute a quorum.

ARTICLE 9

SECTION 9.1: EMBLEM

There shall be an emblem serving as the symbol of the Association, which shall appear on all official documents and property of the Association. The emblem shall depict a circle inscribed

with the name "Chitekesa CDSS Alumni" and the motto "Together We Make the Difference" at the base, incorporating appropriate symbolic imagery representing education and unity.

SECTION 9.2: DATE STAMP

There shall be a date stamp as part of authentication, which shall be stamped on every official document produced, sent out, or received by the Association.

SECTION 9.3: RULES REGARDING THE COMMON SEAL

The custodians of the common seal of the Association shall be the President and the Secretary General. The common seal shall be used only for bank and financial transactions and other relevant official documents.

SECTION 9.4: USAGE RESTRICTIONS

- The common seal shall not be accessible by any member except the President and the Secretary General.
- Modifications, unauthorized reproduction, or copying of the seal are strictly prohibited.
- The seal shall not be used as a replacement for the Association's emblem.

SECTION 9.5: MEMBERSHIP

- Membership is open to all former students who attended Chitekesa CDSS.
- Honorary membership may be conferred by the Executive Committee on distinguished individuals who have contributed significantly to the Association or to Chitekesa CDSS.
- There shall be a membership registration fee and an annual subscription fee for every member. The amounts shall be determined from time to time by the Executive Committee.
- Failure to pay the annual subscription fee shall result in suspension of membership benefits, though the member may rejoin upon payment of the outstanding fee.
- Members are free to voluntarily withdraw their membership by written notice to the Secretary General.
- Former students who graduated from Chitekesa CDSS and are in good standing with the Association shall qualify as full members.

ARTICLE 10: ELECTIONS

Elections for all executive positions shall be held every three (3) years, at the Annual General Meeting designated for that purpose, or at a Special General Meeting called for the purpose of elections.

- After serving one full term in the executive, members may seek re-election to the same position for one additional term. No person shall hold the same position for more than two consecutive terms.
- All those aspiring to contest elections for any position shall register their candidacy with the Electoral Commission at least seven (7) days before the election date.
- An Electoral Commission (EC) shall be constituted by the Executive Committee, comprising not less than four (4) members who are not contesting any position.
- The EC shall be exempt from the voting process.
- Elections shall follow the principle of simple majority on the basis of one person, one vote. Only registered members in good standing shall be allowed to vote.
- In the event of a tie, a second vote shall be conducted. If the tie persists, the outgoing President shall cast a deciding vote.
- Results of elections shall be announced immediately after counting and shall be binding unless successfully contested through a formal objection filed with the EC within forty-eight (48) hours.

ARTICLE 11

SECTION 11.1: SOCIAL WELFARE

The Association shall address the following welfare issues of its members:

- Financial contributions shall be made towards a member who is bereaved of a close relative (i.e., biological father, mother, child, spouse, or biological sibling). The amounts shall be as determined by the Executive Committee.
- The Association shall assist members experiencing financial hardship through welfare funds where available.

- For social cohesion, the Association shall organize seminars, symposia, field trips, excursions, and other social events as discussed and approved by members.
- The Association shall support current students at Chitekesa CDSS through academic and financial assistance.

SECTION 11.2: DISCIPLINE, GRIEVANCES AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

- Any member who contravenes the provisions of this Constitution or the regulations of the Association shall be subjected to disciplinary measures.
- The Disciplinary Committee shall investigate and recommend disciplinary measures against any such member.
- Grievances from members shall be submitted in writing to the Secretary General or raised orally at a General Meeting. The Executive Committee, upon admitting such grievances, shall take necessary steps to address them within four (4) weeks of submission.
- Members of the Association shall live in harmony and settle disputes amicably among themselves.
- Should amicable settlement fail, the Disciplinary Committee shall be convened to assist in settling any matters of dispute.
- A member who is aggrieved by a decision of the Disciplinary Committee may appeal to the Executive Committee within fourteen (14) days. The decision of the Executive Committee on appeal shall be final.

ARTICLE 12: DISSOLUTION OF THE ASSOCIATION

The Association may be dissolved at any time by a resolution passed by not less than two-thirds majority of the fully registered membership present at a Special General Meeting convened for that purpose. Not less than twenty-one (21) days' notice of such a meeting shall be given to all members. Upon dissolution, after settling all outstanding debts and liabilities, any remaining assets of the Association shall be donated to Chitekesa CDSS or to a charitable organization as agreed by the members at the dissolution meeting.

RATIFICATION AND APPROVAL

This Constitution was approved as the binding document of the Chitekesa Community Day Secondary School Alumni Association.

Signed and adopted on this ___2nd___ day of __JUNE___ in the year __2026___.

PRESIDENT Name: Francisco M Kaelama Signature:  Date: 2ND of June 2026	SECRETARY GENERAL Name: Patrick Chibisa Signature: _____ Date: 2ND of June 2026
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Certified as a True Copy of the Constitution of the Chitekesa CDSS Alumni Association

This Constitution was formulated by

FRANCISCO KAELAMA

First President of the Chitekesa CDSS Alumni Association

"Together We Make the Difference"

Chitekesa CDSS Alumni Association
